



## COMMON DSLR MISTAKES AMATEURS MAKE, AND HOW TO AVOID THEM

Digital single-lens reflex cameras – or DSLRs, as they are widely known – are capable of adapting to any shooting conditions to get a good image, and are quite versatile in doing so. Moreover, DSLRs give the added advantage of interchangeable lenses, giving them the ability to shoot close macro images as well as long-distance images with ease. With entry-level DSLRs available in India at around 24k from companies such as Nikon, Canon and Sony, people are more inclined towards buying DSLRs rather than normal point-and-shoot cameras.

Shooting good images and getting consistent results is not too difficult while using a DSLR if you can use these 10 tips and tricks to up your game:



### Choose the right lens

Most of the entry level cameras today come bundled with 18-55mm zoom lenses. People usually think that if they spend slightly more for a higher-end model, they will get better photographs. This is a common misconception as most of the basic DSLRs



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come with 14-18 megapixel crop sensors, which are quite sufficient for getting non-pixelated images of sizes up to 14"×10" (A4). Higher megapixel sensors are useful only if you are shooting images for big posters (27"×40"), to avoid pixelation. An extra macro or zoom lens, on other hand, will help you take a variety of different photographs with ease.



### Read the user manual

If you are a first time user of DSLR, then the user manual is good place to start so that you can avoid unwanted hassles if you know your way around the camera.



### Hold the camera properly

Holding the camera either with one hand or diagonally is a complete no-no. DSLRs are meant to be held with both hands, with the camera's handgrip in the right hand, and the left hand cradling the body and the lens. Also, putting one of your feet forward about half a pace and towards the side provides more stability to the body.



### Use manual modes

If you intend to use the auto mode every time you plan to take a picture, it is a com-

plete waste of the money you invested in buying the DSLR (you could have, instead, bought a point-and-shoot and saved around 15k). Do not be afraid to make mistakes and learn from them (Batman quote - "Why do we fall? So we can learn to pick ourselves up.") Also, it is not necessary to use only the manual mode - try using modes such as aperture priority (Av) and shutter priority (Tv)



Auto - the bane of the DSLR



### Get Sharp Pictures

Not checking pictures after clicking - Sometimes, you will find that pictures which looked fine when you clicked them on the DSLR LCD look blurry on big screens. One way to avoid this is to zoom in the pictures in the LCD screen to 100%. If your pictures are blurry after clicking, you can try the same compositions by using a fast shutter speed and reducing the camera shake.



### Balance the camera

Using a telephoto lens of 2-135mm, 70-200mm or



There is no dearth of lens options available in the market



Holding the DSLR correctly makes a lot of difference